WashU Olin Business

Chase Wiedemann

2026-2027 Academic Job Market Candidate

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Citizenship: United States

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Public Finance
Secondary: Industrial Organization, Regional Economics

EDUCATION

Washington University in St. Louis, Olin Business School *Expected May 2027*
Ph.D. in Business Economics
Dissertation: *Essays on Local Government Organization*
Committee: Brad Larsen (chair), Stephen P. Ryan, and Barton H. Hamilton

The University of Texas at Austin *2021*
M.A. in Economics

Lawrence University *2020*
B.A. in Economics and Mathematics

RESEARCH

Job Market Paper

Coordination vs. Competition: Local Government Centralization and Metropolitan Growth

Working Papers

Economic Dynamism and Local Government Centralization, with Avinash Sattiraju

Works in Progress

Local Government Organization and Endogenous Policy Choice in Public Safety

The Role of Organization in Local Government Labor Markets

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Washington University in St. Louis, Olin Business School

Teaching Assistant, Econometrics *Fall 2026*
Instructor: Enrique Luccioni

Teaching Assistant, Intermediate Microeconomics *Fall 2024-Spring 2026*
David Ahn (Spring 2025, Spring 2026); Cecilia Diaz Campo (Fall 2024)

Teaching Assistant, Health Economics *Fall 2025*
Instructor: Cecilia Diaz Campo

Teaching Assistant, Competitive Industry Analysis and Strategy Development *Spring 2023*
Instructor: Stephen P. Ryan

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Stephen P. Ryan, Washington University in St. Louis *Fall 2022-Spring 2024*
Implemented Java extensions to the discrete-choice moment-inequality estimator in Dickstein and Morales, "What Do Exporters Know?"

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: R, Java

REFERENCES

Brad Larsen
Associate Professor of Economics
Olin Business School, Washington University in St. Louis
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Barton H. Hamilton
Robert Brookings Smith Distinguished Professor of Economics, Management & Entrepreneurship
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Stephen P. Ryan
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RESEARCH ABSTRACTS

Job Market Paper

Coordination vs. Competition: Local Government Centralization and Metropolitan Growth

This paper examines how local government organization affects metropolitan growth. My focus is on local government centralization, which I measure using the distribution of local government employment across jurisdictions within U.S. metropolitan statistical areas. As local government is only a subset of the larger institutional framework operating in metropolitan areas, the relationship between organization and growth may be endogenous. To address this, I use an instrumental variables strategy based on post office closures following the introduction of Rural Free Delivery in 1902. In both the OLS and IV specifications, I find that more centralized MSAs experience greater population and private employment growth. Examining mechanisms, I find that centralized metros employ more local government workers, collect more revenue, and are less likely to host data centers, a highly tax-sensitive form of mobile capital. The findings suggest that, at the metropolitan scale, internalizing cross-jurisdictional externalities may be more important for growth than increased competition between governments.

Working Papers

Economic Dynamism and Local Government Centralization, with Avinash Sattiraju

Economic dynamism, the reallocation of economic resources through establishment entry and exit, exhibits persistent cross-sectional variation across U.S. metropolitan areas. While recent spatial macroeconomic models explain the divergence across city sizes via scale-biased technology adoption and worker sorting, they do not account for why metropolitan areas of comparable population, land area, and human capital sustain permanently different rates of dynamism. We show that the local government organization is a central driver of this variation. Using historical post office closures from the 1902 rollout of Rural Free Delivery to instrument for contemporary local government centralization, we find that a one-standard-deviation increase in centralization raises economic dynamism by over half a standard deviation. Centralization also predicts three downstream features of dynamic economies: higher generative AI adoption, greater labor specialization, and larger unemployment spikes during recessions. Contrary to the view that jurisdictional competition necessarily disciplines local governance, our evidence suggests that fragmented metropolitan governance weakens extensive-margin market selection by reducing entry and exit and shifting activity toward older incumbents, a pattern consistent with incumbent protection as a source of misallocation.